

Closing Out and Archiving a Client

Mary's Hands Network | Doula Team Process and Communication Guide

Every doula is expected to request to archive and close out their own clients once services are complete. There are two ways a case closes: the client finishes services, or the client stops responding. This guide walks through both, with the language to use and exactly what to send the administrative team. Every archive request goes to Kerionne.

Key contact

Kerionne Lewis, Volunteer Coordinator
klewis@mhndoula.com

Before you do anything: timing

Do not archive any client before 4 weeks postpartum.

The transition into life with a new baby is when the most mental health concerns arise. It is imperative that we do everything we can to keep clients connected to postpartum support before a case is ever closed.

Path 1: The client completed services

Use this path when the client has finished their birth doula services.

1. Send the client a quick text letting them know their birth doula services are complete, that you are passing them to the administrative team, and that an email with the details is on the way.
2. Send the client a formal completion email and CC Kerionne. Confirm services are complete and the case is moving to the admin team, and ask whether they are interested in extended postpartum services.
3. If the client says yes to extended postpartum services, send Kerionne the client CIN and the final date of service.

Text template: heads-up to the client

Hi [Client Name], it has been such a joy supporting you. Your birth doula services with Mary's Hands Network are now complete, so I am passing you to our administrative team to close out your case. Look out for an email from me shortly with the details. Thank you for letting us be part of your journey.

Email template: completion of services (CC Kerionne)

Subject: Completion of your birth doula services with Mary's Hands Network

Dear [Client Name],

It has been an honor to support you through your birth journey. As I mentioned by text, your services with the Mary's Hands Network birth doula team are now complete, and your case will be passed to our administrative team to be closed out.

Before we do, I want to be sure you know that extended postpartum support is available to you. The weeks after birth are a tender season, and our postpartum services are here to help. If you would like to continue with postpartum support, simply reply to this email and let me know.

Thank you for allowing us to walk alongside you.

Warmly,

[Your Name]

CC: Kerionne Lewis, klewis@mhndoula.com

If the client wants extended postpartum services

Send Kerionne a short note with these two items:

Send to Kerionne	What to include
klewis@mhndoula.com	Client CIN
	Final date of service

Path 2: The client stops responding

Use this path when a client goes quiet or does not take up postpartum services. We do not rush the close. Instead, we make one meaningful, escalating attempt each week so the client always has a door open during the season they need us most. A client is never archived before 4 weeks postpartum.

Step 1: One outreach attempt each week

When	Action
Week 1	Send two text messages a few days apart, checking in on mom and baby and inviting them to postpartum support
Week 2	Make a phone call. If there is no answer, leave a warm voicemail and follow with a text
Week 3	Send an email and CC Kerionne, noting that you have been trying to reach them and that postpartum support is still available
Week 4	Make one final attempt by call or text
End of week 4	If there is still no response, and the client is at least 4 weeks postpartum, you may archive

If a client goes quiet later in the postpartum period rather than at the start, pick up the cadence from that week and still complete the week 3 email and a final week 4 attempt before archiving.

Email template: week 3 notice to the client (CC Kerionne)

This email does double duty. With the client name and CIN included and Kerionne copied, it serves as notice to both the client and the administrative team that the case is heading toward closeout. It is not the archive request itself.

Subject: Checking in from your Mary's Hands Network doula

Dear [Client Name],

I have been trying to reach you over the past few weeks and want to make sure you and your baby are doing well. I would love to connect about the postpartum support available to you, because this season after birth is exactly when that care matters most.

Please reply to this email or call me at [your phone] so we can find a time to talk. If I do not hear from you, your case will be closed out by our administrative team after a final check-in next week.

Thinking of you,
[Your Name]

Client: [Client Name] | CIN: [CIN]

CC: Kerionne Lewis, klewis@mhndoula.com

Step 2: Send a specific archive request after the week 4 attempt

Even though Kerionne was copied on the week 3 notice, archiving always requires a separate, specific request. If the final week 4 attempt goes unanswered and the client is at least 4 weeks postpartum, email Kerionne a clear archive request with the client CIN and the reason. Kerionne will then notify the client that they are being moved to archived and services completed.

Email template: archive request to Kerionne

To: klewis@mhndoula.com

Subject: Archive request, client did not respond to outreach

Hi Kerionne,

I am requesting to archive the following client, who did not respond to our weekly outreach.

Client CIN: [CIN]

Reason: Client did not respond to weekly outreach across four weeks postpartum (texts, a phone call, and an email with you copied, plus a final attempt in week 4).

Thank you,
[Your Name]

Quick reference: what to send Kerionne

Situation	What to send
Client completed services and wants extended postpartum	Email klewis@mhndoula.com with the client CIN and the final date of service
Client did not respond and is ready to archive	Email klewis@mhndoula.com with the client CIN and the reason (no response to weekly outreach)

When in doubt, keep trying to reach the client before closing a case. Postpartum support is where we make the biggest difference.